

you will have good success” (Joshua 1:8). James 1:25 says something very similar. Moses said to the Israelites: “Set your hearts on all the words which I testify among you today, which you shall command your children to be careful to observe—all the words of this law. For it is not a futile thing for you, because it is your life” (Deuteronomy 32:46-47). A very great many Christians, from around the world, have found the above to be true in their personal experience.

Romans 1:16-17, “I am not ashamed¹ of the Gospel of Christ,² because it is the power of God for the salvation of each one who believes (for the Jew first, then the Greek); because in it God’s righteousness is revealed, from faith to faith; just as it is written: ‘The righteous one will live by faith’.”³ The Gospel is the power for the salvation. As Sovereign Jesus said in John 14:6—“I am the way, the truth, and the life. No one comes to the Father except through me.” There are not many ways, only one. Millions of lives have been transformed by the power of God’s Word; so where did that power come from?

The inspiration of the Sacred Text is an intrinsic quality; it is because it is. However, we can perceive the inherent quality, comparing inspired material with material that is not inspired. Consider the nature of the Bible’s content, or message: it is not the sort of thing that the human being would wish to write, even if he could; nor is it the sort of thing that he could write, even if he wished to. And then there is the unity of the Bible: even though the 66 books were written by at least thirty different human authors, during some 2,000 years, and in two very different languages (Hebrew and Greek),⁴ the whole is coherent, it does not contradict itself. There are also specific and detailed prophecies, even including a person’s name, given centuries before the fact, that were precisely fulfilled.

For those who believe Jesus Christ to be God, His attitude toward the Old Testament will be relevant. He ascribed absolute authority to the OT; in John 5:45-47 He placed the writings of Moses on a par with His own word, that He declared to have eternal validity (Luke 21:33). As reported in the four Gospels, He cited at least Genesis, Exodus, Numbers, Deuteronomy, Psalms, Isaiah, Jeremiah, Daniel, Hosea, Jonah, Zechariah and Malachi. In Luke 24:44 He explicitly recognized the three divisions of the

¹ Where did Paul get the idea of ‘shame’? A world controlled by Satan does all it can to cow any who dare to proclaim the Truth.

² Perhaps 3% of the Greek manuscripts omit “of Christ”, to be followed by NIV, NASB, TEV, etc.—an inferior proceeding.

³ See Habakkuk 2:4. To ‘live by faith’ you must move from one exercise of faith to another.

⁴ A very few chapters were written in Aramaic.